

SanDisk iXpand Wireless Charger 15W

Every storage manufacturer out there has been either expanding their peripheral categories or innovating by combining multiple devices to build Frankenstein's monster. SanDisk has entered the wireless charging segment with their new iXpand Wireless Chargers. Some of these are Fast Charge capable chargers whereas others are 2-in-1 devices which charge and backup data at the same time.

The SanDisk iXpand Wireless Charger is a simple Qualcomm Quick Charge 3.0 certified charger that's rated to run at 15W. It comes with a 24W Fast Charger which enables quick charging, otherwise you can still use the device with any other charger and it will still get the job done, albeit very slowly. The wall unit comes with a 1.5m long cable which means you have plenty of length to get some cable management done.



The charger itself conforms to a circular form-factor which is the most common with wireless chargers these days. The top surface has a thin rubber ring around the edges to provide some grip to whatever device is being charged and the bottom also comes with a nice thick rubber base that runs along the circumference. Right next to it are little vents peppered along the circumference to help cool the device during extended periods of use. And lastly, it uses a USB Type-C interface.

The inside has several protection mechanisms such as temperature control and foreign object detection to keep your mind at ease. We used the device to charge True Wireless Earphones such as the Jabra 85t since those tend to take the right amount of time to get charged. Charging a smartphone with about 5,000 mAh takes up way too much time with any wireless charger, even if it has fast charging. Unless of course, you use it to charge your phone overnight, in which case, this is a great buy.

PRICE: ₹2,699



Lotoo PAW S1

Lotoo is a pretty well-established name in the audiophile circles after bringing critically-acclaimed products such as the Lotoo Paw Gold and the Lotoo Paw Gold Touch. Their newest offering is the Lotoo Paw S1, a portable USB DAC-Amp priced at ₹11,990. The Paw S1 comes equipped with the AK4377 DAC chip alongside an OPA1622 chip. Inside the box, you get a USB Type-C to Type-C OTG cable, a USB Type-C to USB Type-A connector cable for PCs or laptops, and some stickers and paperwork. The device has a svelte black aluminium body that looks premium and feels sturdy. On the front, there's a small OLED screen that cycles between showing volume levels, EQ modes and gain levels. The bottom features two audio outputs – a 3.5mm output and a 4.4mm output. This is one of the few dongles with a screen and two audio outputs, making it pretty unique. The 4.4mm output is the balanced output and provides users with a lower noise floor and higher input power. On top, there's a USB Type-C port. You can plug in the provided OTG cable here and connect it to your source device. The dongle works pretty flawlessly, without the need for a driver or any app. There are also three buttons that can be used to adjust EQ modes, gain modes, and volume levels. We tested the dongle with the Shure AONIC 5 IEMs paired up to a Samsung Galaxy S20 Ultra. The dongle provides a low noise floor on both audio outputs and has a fairly neutral sound signature. The soundstage is expansive and the separation is excellent. For those looking for a reference-grade USB dongle, the Lotoo Paw S1 is definitely one of the best choices.

PRICE: ₹11,990